13. Keay, John, *India: A History*, HarperCollins, 2000.
14. McCrindle, J.W. (translator), ‘Ancient India as Described by Megasthenes and Arrian: A Translation of Fragments of Indika of Megasthenes Collected by Dr. Schwanbeck, and of the First Part of Indika of Arrian’, Trubner and Co., 1877.
15. Ibid., p. 23. McCrindle writes that these creatures ‘might be more readily confounded with other creatures of the Indian imagination, who held a sort of intermediate place between demons and men’, such as rakshasas, pishachas, and others. Historian Truesdell Sparhawk Brown also held that Megasthenes ‘reproduced correctly what his own eyes had seen’ and ‘what his Indian informants told him’. Source: Allan Dahlaquist, *Megasthenes and Indian Religion: A Study in Motives and Types*, Motilal Banarsidass, 1996, p. 28.
16. Kulke, Hermann, Dietmar Rothermund, *A History of India*, Psychology Press, 2004, p. 62.
17. Quote from an ASI information panel at the Kumrahar archaeological site museum in Patna.
18. Sen, Sudipta, *Ganga: The Many Pasts of a River*, Viking, 2019, p. 136.
19. McCrindle, J.W. (translator), ‘The Indica of Arrian’, Education Society’s Press, Byculla, 1876, p. 32.
20. Thapar, Romila, *Early India*, Penguin Books, 2002, pp. 184–85.
21. In 1030 CE, Alberuni made a similar observation. ‘The Hindus eat singly, one by one,’ he wrote. See Alberuni, Edward C. Sachau (translator, 1888), *Alberuni’s India*, Rupa Publications, Delhi, 2002.
22. Ibid., p. 192.
23. Ibid., p. 164.

Chapter 3: The Void of Nagarjunakonda

1. Subrahmanyam, R., et al., *Nagarjunakonda (1954–60)*, ASI, 1975, Vol. I, pp. xviii–xix.
2. All quotes in this and the previous paragraph are from Longhurst, A.H., *Buddhist Antiquities of Nagarjunakonda*, ASI, 1938, pp. 2–6.
3. Ibid., pp. 2–6.
4. Subrahmanyam, R., et al., *Nagarjunakonda (1954–60)*, ASI, 1975, Vol. I, p. 202.